

JUSTIFICATION REVIEW DOCUMENT
FAR PART 16 EXCEPTION TO FAIR OPPORTUNITY JUSTIFICATION
For Actions Exceeding the Simplified Acquisition Threshold (SAT)

Program/Equipment: United States Military Academy (USMA) Modernization of West Point Research and Education Network (WREN)

Authority: FAR 16.505(a)(4) – Restricting consideration to an item peculiar to one manufacturer (e.g., a particular brand-name, product, or a feature of a product that is peculiar to one manufacturer).

Amount: \$2,000,000.00

Prepared by:	Ignacio Cordova Contract Specialist E-	COM: Date: 05 MAR 2025 I
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Contracting Officer:	Jarrod Bowsky Contract Officer	COM: Date: 24 MAR 2025
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Technical:	Jon Muir Chief, Network Engineer Br.	COM: 9 Date: 17 MAR 2025
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Requirements:	Stephen Thorenz Chief, Resource & Acquisitions	COM: 2 Date: 18 MAR 2025
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Reviews: I have reviewed this justification and find it adequate to support other than full and open competition.

Program Manager:

COM:

Date: See Digital Signature

Small Business Professional:

COM:

Date: See digital signature

Local Legal Counsel:
DAVID BOSCO

Director, MICC–West Point:
KYMBERLY AVILES

Assistant Director, Small Business Program:
ERIC RAVELLI

MICC Office of Counsel:
FRANK MARCH

**FAR Part 16 Exception to Fair Opportunity Justification
Under Multiple Award Indefinite Delivery Contracts
For Actions Exceeding the Simplified Acquisition Threshold (SAT)**

1. Contracting Activity: U.S. Army Mission and Installation Contracting Command – West Point, (MICC – WP), 681 Rogers Place, West Point, New York 10996-1514

2. Description of Action: The USMA requests a firm-fixed-price task order with a CHES ITES-3H vendor capable of providing Cisco brand name products. The Government projects award for March 2025 and fiscal year 2025, Other Procurement Army funds will be used. An acquisition plan is not required because this procurement does not meet the threshold at Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement 207.103(d)(i)(B).

3. Description of Supplies/Services: The USMA requires modernization of their existing West Point Research and Education Network (WREN) that
This modernization is required by Army CIO Directive to implement Internet Protocol version and mandates by both the Department of Defense (DoD) and Army to implement the . The WREN consists of a variety of high-end Cisco points. Cisco products required to complete this modernization of the WREN are contained in the following table.

Cisco Products

No.	Part Number	Description	Qty
1	C9606R	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 6 Slot Chassis	4
2	C9600-NW-A	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Network Advantage License	8
3	C9600-CAMPUS-CORE	Catalyst 9600 Campus Core Deployment; For Tracking Only	4
4	C9606-FAN	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series C9606 Chassis Fan Tray	4
5	C9606-SLOT-BLANK	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series Blank for Chassis Module Slot	4
6	C9606-PWR-BLANK	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series Blank for Power Supply Slot	4
7	C9K-F2-SSD-960GB	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 960GB SSD Storage	4
8	NETWORK-PNP-LIC	Network Plug-n-Play Connect for zero-touch device deployment	4
9	C9600-DNA-A	Cisco Catalyst 9600 DNA Advantage Term License	4
10	C9600-DNA-A-3Y	Cisco Catalyst 9600 DNA Advantage 3 Year License	4
11	S9600UK9-1712	Cisco Catalyst 9600 XE 17.12 UNIVERSAL	4

No.	Part Number	Description	Qty
12	C9600-LC-24C	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 24-Port 40GE/12-Port 100GE	4
13	C9600-LC-48YL	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 48-Port 25GE/10GE/1GE	4
14	C9600-LC-48YL	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 48-Port 25GE/10GE/1GE	4
15	C9600-PWR-2KWAC	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 2000W AC Power Supply	12
16	CAB-TA-NA	North America AC Type A Power Cable	12
17	C9000-HSEC	U.S. Export Restriction Compliance license for Catalyst 9000	4
18	C9600X-SUP-2	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series Supervisor 2 Module	4
19	C9600X-SUP-2/2	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series Redundant Supervisor 2 Module	4
20	C9K-F2-SSD-960GB	Cisco Catalyst 9600 Series 960GB SSD Storage	4
21	C8500-12X4QC	Cisco Catalyst 8500-12X4QC Edge Platform	4
22	C-RFID-NONE	Cisco Catalyst 8000 Edge - NO RFID	4
23	MEM-C8500-16GB	Cisco C8500 16GB DRAM	4
24	C8500-ACCKIT-19	Cisco C8500 Accessory Kit - 19" rack	4
25	NETWORK-PNP-LIC	Network Plug-n-Play Connect for zero-touch device deployment	4
26	C8000-HSEC	U.S. Export Restriction Compliance license for C8000 series	4
27	SC8KAEPUK9-176	UNIVERSAL	4
28	IOSXE-AUTO-MODE	IOS XE Autonomous or SD-Routing mode for Unified image	4
29	PWR-CH1-750WACR	Cisco C8500/CW9800 750W AC Power Supply	8
30	CAB-AC	AC Power Cord (North America), C13, NEMA 5-15P, 2.1m	8
31	DNA-P-T3-A-3Y	Cisco DNA Advantage On-Prem Lic 3Y – up to 10G (Aggr, 20G)	4
32	DSTACK-T3-A	Cisco DNA Advantage Stack – up to 10G (Aggr, 20G)	4
33	NWSTACK-T3-A	Cisco Network Advantage Stack – up to 10G (Aggr, 20G)	4
34	SDWAN-UMB-ADV	Cisco Umbrella for DNA Advantage	4
35	DNAC-ONPREM-PF	Cisco DNA Center On Prem Deployment Option for WAN	4
36	TE-EMBED-WANI	Cisco Thousand Eyes WAN Insights Embedded	4
37	SVS-PDNA-ADV	Embedded Support for SW - Tiered DNA Advantage On-Prem	4
38	C85-12X4QC-PF	C8500-12X4QC Platform Selection for DNA Subscription	4
39	IOSXE-AUTO-MODE-PF	IOS XE Autonomous or SD-Routing mode for Unified image	4

No.	Part Number	Description	Qty
40	FPR4200-FTD-HA-BUN	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Threat Defense Chss, Subs HA Bundle	3
41	FPR4215-NGFW-K9	Cisco Secure Firewall 4215 NGFW Appliance, 1U, 2xNetMod Bays	6
42	PWR-CAB-AC-USA	Power Cord for AC V2 Power Module (USA)	6
43	SF-F4K-TD7.4-K9	Cisco Secure Firewall TD 7.4 SW for 4200 series appliances	6
44	FPR4200-SSD1800	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Series 1.8TB SSD	12
45	FPR4200-SLD-RAILS	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Slide Rail Kit	6
46	CAB-CONS-RJ45-DB9	Console Cable 6ft with RJ45 and DB9F	6
47	FPR4215-BSE	Cisco Secure Firewall 4215 Base License	6
48	FPR4200-PWR-AC	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Series AC Power Supply	6
49	FPR4200-PSU-BLANK	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Series Chassis PWR Blnk Slot Cover	6
50	FPR4200-FAN	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Series Fan	18
51	FPR4200-NM-BLANK	Cisco Secure Firewall 4200 Network Module Blank Slot Cover	12
52	L-FPR4215T-T=	Cisco Secure Firewall 4215 Threat Defence License	6
53	L-FPR4215T-T-3Y	Cisco Secure Firewall 4215 Threat Defence 3Y Subs	6

Delivery Date June 30, 2025

Total Value: \$ 2,000,000.00

4. Authority Cited: FAR 16.505(a)(4) – Restricting consideration to an item peculiar to one manufacturer (e.g., a particular brand-name, product, or a feature of a product that is peculiar to one manufacturer).

5. Reason for Authority Cited:

a. Background. The West Point WREN network infrastructure is completely on Cisco Systems network hardware. The WREN consists of a variety of

All network are based on Cisco wired and wireless hardware and their components. The environment has been in place since 2019 and enables specific educational and

can only exist through the employment of an technology as is found on the WREN.

Based on the research conducted by the CIO/G6, the only way to continue to provide the capability required by the EDU Network (EDU) and research missions is to provide a component lifecycle replacement in the network requires unique hardware implementation and configuration of the WREN. The WREN administrators within the Network Services Branch (NSB) The average WREN engineer’s training is estimated at approximately per year to maintain currency with evolving industry standards.

If and systems were introduced to the WREN, the and could lead to inoperability. Introduction of additional costs for training of the network engineers to manage and respond to new variables added to the network. the WREN’s development and the performance of these components fell short of the baseline network requirements. components cannot meet the network parameters of the WREN.

Given the existing hardware footprint and the requirement for an capability, the estimated amount of funding that would be required to replace all existing hardware with hardware , as well as any support and maintenance contracts, would cost approximately \$10 million and would result in approximately experienced during the Academic Year. This cost would be exponentially higher if multiple vendors were integrated within the WREN. Additionally, the replacement of all devices would g employees approximately 10,000 hours at an estimated labor cost of \$2.4 million which would the WREN operate the WREN would be required to ware and replace the existing hardware.

Cost Impact of Changing from a Cisco Homogeneous Network

Task	Estimated Cost
Hardware cost for complete replacement and new equipment maintenance contracts	
Network engineer training investment for new vendor equipment	
Government Labor Cost to Replace all Devices (10K hours)	
Network operation contracts	
Total changeover costs	

In today's digital world, a high-performance router for processing and transmitting large amounts of data is required. High-performance routers and components have the capabilities to handle the massive data requirements and still provide accessibility and reliability service to the organization. If the brand of equipment supporting the WREN were to be changed, the personnel supporting the WREN Network Operations Center would hardware in place and it would take a

Integrating a component into the WREN would not be compatible with Cisco software protocols for installation and integration methods and would create result in a WREN. The of using non-Cisco hardware could failure and limit the availability of this important USMA resource.

b. Alternatives. The CIO/G6 has evaluated several vendors to include are in use elsewhere in the Army. company offers the broad variety of hardware required to operate within the WREN, nor would they be a suitable replacement to create a as required by the WREN support mission. WREN and result , the existing monitoring and packages . Additionally, the WREN utilizes specific management

These protocols are specific to the Cisco brand and do not interoperate correctly with other vendors. Employment of alternatives

c. Impact if Justification not approved: To successfully modernize the WREN requires implementation and configuration of unique hardware.

. Without maintaining the existing through lifecycle replacements of Cisco components with newer Cisco components, the WREN's support of the Academy's mission would be significantly degraded.

6. Actions to Increase Competition: The Contracting Officer shall publish the notices required by FAR 5.201. A sources sought notice was posted on the CHES IT E-mart for ITES-3H vendors on November 21, 2024. Five vendors responded to the notice, supporting the existence of competition.

a. **Effective Competition:** Market research for this procurement included posting a sources sought notice on CHES IT E-mart on November 21, 2024, which yielded five ITES-3H vendors who responded, supporting the existence of competition. There were not two or more capable socio-economic small business concerns to identify and classify as a socio-economic set-aside.

b. **Subcontracting Competition:** Subcontracting does not apply; the procurement is for a purchase of supplies; Brand Name Cisco Components through the CHES IT E-mart Platform.

7. Market Research: A sources sought notice was posted on CHES IT E-mart for ITES-3H vendors on November 21, 2024. Five ITES-3H vendors responded that were interested in supplying the required components. There were not two or more capable socio-economic small business concerns to identify and classify as a socio-economic set-aside. CHES is the mandatory source for this procurement.

The requirement shall be posted on the CHES IT E-mart as CHES is the Army's mandatory source for these types of purchases. Competition is present for this Brand Name requirement.

8. Other Facts: MICC-West Point has no previous procurement history for similar requirements.

9. Technical Certification: I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

JON MUIR
Chief, NSB Engineer Branch

10. Requirements Certification: I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

STEPHEN THORENZ
Chief, Resource and Acquisitions

11. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination: I hereby determine that the anticipated cost or price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable. This determination will be derived from competition amongst CHESS ITES-3H Vendors. As a part of this basis, certified cost or pricing data will not be required and the following exception applies (FAR 15.403): Prices that will be agreed upon are based on adequate

JARROD BOWSKY
Contracting Officer

12. Contracting Officer Certification: I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

JARROD BOWSKY
Contracting Officer

Approval

Based on the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Cisco brand name components for the modernization of the USMA WREN using an exception to fair opportunity pursuant to the authority of FAR 16.505(a)(4) – Restricting consideration to an item peculiar to one manufacturer. The estimated value of the contract is \$2 million with an estimated delivery date of June 30, 2025. This approval is subject to availability of funds, and provided that the services or supplies herein described have otherwise been authorized for acquisition.

SCOTT D. KUKES

Alternate Advocate for Competition

U.S. Army Mission and Installation Contracting Command, JBSA Fort Sam Houston, TX